



ULAB

**UNIVERSITY OF LIBERAL ARTS
BANGLADESH**

Course Code: MSJ3151

Semester: Summer 2025

News Sourcing and Gathering

Submitted To

Mahmudunnabi

University of Liberal Arts Bangladesh (ULAB)

Submitted by

Yasir Arafat

ID 213012001

ULAB Students Voice Mixed Opinions on Campus Politics

Students at University of Liberal Arts Bangladesh (ULAB) also had different views about campus politics, some of them believed that campus politics has the possibility of nurturing potential leaders while others did not agree with the idea and were worried about the effects of campus politics on academic life.

“Student politics should be a platform for leadership and awareness not for violence,” said MSJ student Muskan Parvej in an interview. “Politics is a part of our society and students cannot isolate themselves from it. But it must be constructive, not destructive,” she said.

The interview was held in the ULAB Campus in Mohammadpur on [03/09/2025]. It is representative of increasing discussions in the youth at a time when Bangladeshi student politics itself is a hotly debated topic.

Muskan Parvej said, Student politics had a significant role in the history of democratic movements of Bangladesh like Language Movement, Liberation War etc. But, she added, student enrolment has been discouraged because the campus politics today are very violent.

She recommended that politics be reformulated into issue-based platforms: “We need a culture in which students discuss policies and social issues and not one another.” She suggested workshops, awareness programs and debates as an alternative to party clashes.

Additional Perspectives:

Other ULAB students also voiced anxiety. “It distracts from the studies.” Another student said, “I stay away from politics. My priority is now for me to finish my degree.” A female student also raised the need for inclusivity: “Politics, it just feels so male-dominated. If it is to be a school for both sexes, then women ought to be admitted already.

Background:

Among the students, campus politics has been considerably vibrant but also controversial in Bangladesh history. Though it generated numerous national leaders, it has also been associated with violence and disruptions at public universities. Compared to public universities and colleges, the mood in private universities, such as ULAB, remains relatively apolitical giving students the space to attend academics.

Conclusion:

The interviews reveal that ULAB students want politics but in a peaceful and constructive way and friendly towards educational institutions. Or as one student put it: “Politics is supposed to make us better citizens, not make us scared of ourselves.”

Interview Questions with Answers

Q1. Could you please tell us about yourself (name, department, year, research interests, etc.)?

A: I am Muskan Parvej. Editor's Note: I am 3rd year student from Department of MSJ (Media studies and journalism) at ULAB.

Q2. What is campus politics to a student like you?

A: Campus politics for me is students' engagement in the social and political issues that affect their lives. It is to raise awareness, develop leadership skills, and to have input into the things that are happening for young people.

Q3. Do you believe campus politics enables students to develop leadership qualities?

A: Yes, it can. Politics shows students how to debate, organize events and deliver messages effectively. This will capacitate them to lead in society if politics is conducted peacefully and meaningfully.

Q4. What is your view regarding student politics' impact on academics?

A: It can have both. There's an upside that promotes critical thinking and leadership. On the negative, if politics turns violent or partisan, it disrupts learning itself and students won't do as well academically."

Q5. Have you ever been involved in student politics? If so, how was it? If not, why not?

Q: Biggest reason is that I want to concentrate on my studies now. But I do pay attention to political talk, and I do attempt to keep up with student movements in other universities.

Q6. What are the contrasts between student politics at ULAB and public universities?

A: Student politics is visible much more prominently in public universities and often associated with national parties. ULAB is a more academic and serene environment. This enables us to focus on studying, but it constrains us from direct involvement in political activism.

Q7. Do you see that the violence in student politics (in other campuses) has created a bad name for the entire education system?

A: Yes. When violence breaks out in public universities, outsiders have an impression of all students as being violent. Private university students like us also occasionally grapple with stereotypes and while we may have never faced political violence on our campuses.

Q8. What can be done to redefine student politics to help the students?

A: It should be about issues, not parties and all the squabbling that comes with it. A student might, for example, arrange debates, awareness programs or campaigns on education reforms, climate change or women's rights. It would impart meaning to politics.

Q9. Do you think student politics have a role in shaping the future political leaders of Bangladesh?

A: Yes, it does. The student leaders will be tomorrow's national leaders. Done healthily, student politics can be a training ground for young people in leadership, negotiation and working as part of a team, all skills that will be necessary for the future of Bangladesh.

Q10. What's your own message to students who are considering entering student politics?

A: My advice would be to become involved in politics if, for you, it's all about service, but don't let it disrupt your aspirations in academia. Education comes first. Become involved in politics for good and not for war; not for personal enrichment or to score points.



